

```
sysadmin@localhost:~$ date
Mon Sep 28 21:26:38 UTC 2026
sysadmin@localhost:~$
```

type the following command to display today's date:

```
DATE(1)                                User Commands                                DATE(1)
NAME
  date - print or set the system date and time
SYNOPSIS
  date [OPTION]... [+FORMAT]
  date [-u|--utc|--universal] [MMDDhhmm[[CC]YY][.ss]]
DESCRIPTION
  Display the current time in the given FORMAT, or set the system date.
  Mandatory arguments to long options are mandatory for short options too.
  -d, --date=STRING
    display time described by STRING, not 'now'
  --debug
    annotate the parsed date, and warn about questionable usage to stderr
  -F, --file=DATEFILE
    Manual page date(1) line 1 (press h for help or q to quit)
```

man date = show me the Linux manual/documentation for the **date** command.

```

SUMMARY OF LESS COMMANDS

Commands marked with * may be preceded by a number, N.
Notes in parentheses indicate the behavior if N is given.
A key preceded by a caret indicates the Ctrl key; thus ^K is ctrl-K.

h H          Display this help.
q :q Q :Q ZZ Exit.
-----

MOVING

e ^E j ^N CR * Forward one line (or N lines).
y ^Y k ^K ^P * Backward one line (or N lines).
f ^F ^V SPACE * Forward one window (or N lines).
b ^B ESC-v    * Backward one window (or N lines).
z             * Forward one window (and set window to N).
w             * Backward one window (and set window to N).
ESC-SPACE    * Forward one window, but don't stop at end-of-file.
d ^D         * Forward one half-window (and set half-window to N).
u ^U         * Backward one half-window (and set half-window to N).
ESC-) RightArrow * Right one half screen width (or N positions).
HELP -- Press RETURN for more, or q when done
```

The letter **h** to see a list of movement commands

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ man -k password
chage (1)          - change user password expiry information
chgpaswd (8)       - update group passwords in batch mode
chpaswd (8)        - update passwords in batch mode
cpgr (8)           - copy with locking the given file to the password or gr...
cppw (8)           - copy with locking the given file to the password or gr...
expiry (1)         - check and enforce password expiration policy
login.defs (5)     - shadow password suite configuration
pam_pwhistory (8)  - PAM module to remember last passwords
pam_unix (8)       - Module for traditional password authentication
passwd (1)         - change user password
passwd (1ss1)     - compute password hashes
passwd (5)         - the password file
pwck (8)           - verify integrity of password files
pwconv (8)        - convert to and from shadow passwords and groups
shadow (5)        - shadowed password file
shadowconfig (8)  - toggle shadow passwords on and off
unix_chkpwd (8)   - Helper binary that verifies the password of the curren...
unix_update (8)   - Helper binary that updates the password of a given user
vipw (8)          - edit the password, group, shadow-password or shadow-gr...
sysadmin@localhost:~$

```

`-k` option to the `man` command will often produce a huge amount of output

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ apropos password
chage (1)          - change user password expiry information
chgpaswd (8)       - update group passwords in batch mode
chpaswd (8)        - update passwords in batch mode
cpgr (8)           - copy with locking the given file to the password or gr...
cppw (8)           - copy with locking the given file to the password or gr...
expiry (1)         - check and enforce password expiration policy
login.defs (5)     - shadow password suite configuration
pam_pwhistory (8)  - PAM module to remember last passwords
pam_unix (8)       - Module for traditional password authentication
passwd (1)         - change user password
passwd (1ss1)     - compute password hashes
passwd (5)         - the password file
pwck (8)           - verify integrity of password files
pwconv (8)        - convert to and from shadow passwords and groups
shadow (5)        - shadowed password file
shadowconfig (8)  - toggle shadow passwords on and off
unix_chkpwd (8)   - Helper binary that verifies the password of the curren...
unix_update (8)   - Helper binary that updates the password of a given user
vipw (8)          - edit the password, group, shadow-password or shadow-gr...
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```

`apropos` command is another way of viewing man page summaries with a keyword

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ man -f passwd
passwd (5)         - the password file
passwd (1)         - change user password
passwd (1ss1)     - compute password hashes
sysadmin@localhost:~$

```

`man -f passwd` is used to get a **short description of the passwd command and related manual pages**.

```
File: coreutils.info, Node: date invocation, Next: arch invocation, Up: Syst\
em context
```

```
21.1 `date': Print or set system date and time
=====
```

Synopses:

```
date [OPTION]... [+FORMAT]
date [-u|--utc|--universal] [ MMDDhhmm[[CC]YY][.ss] ]
```

Invoking `date' with no FORMAT argument is equivalent to invoking it with a default format that depends on the `LC_TIME' locale category. In the default C locale, this format is `'+%a %b %e %H:%M:%S %Z %Y'', so the output looks like `Thu Mar 3 13:47:51 PST 2005'.

Normally, `date' uses the time zone rules indicated by the `TZ' environment variable, or the system default rules if `TZ' is not set. \*Note Specifying the Time Zone with `TZ': (libc)TZ Variable.

If given an argument that starts with a '+', `date' prints the current date and time (or the date and time specified by the `--date'

```
-----Info: (coreutils)date invocation, 40 lines --Top-----
Welcome to Info version 6.5. Type H for help, h for tutorial.
```

Info date - It provides more detailed documentation about date

```
sysadmin@localhost:~$ date --help
Usage: date [OPTION]... [+FORMAT]
or: date [-u|--utc|--universal] [MMDDhhmm[[CC]YY][.ss]]
Display the current time in the given FORMAT, or set the system date.

-d, --date=STRING      display time described by STRING, not 'now'
-f, --file=DATEFILE    like --date once for each line of DATEFILE
-r, --reference=FILE    display the last modification time of FILE
-R, --rfc-2822          output date and time in RFC 2822 format.
                        Example: Mon, 07 Aug 2006 12:34:56 -0600
--rfc-3339=TIMESPEC    output date and time in RFC 3339 format.
                        TIMESPEC='date', 'seconds', or 'ns' for
                        date and time to the indicated precision.
                        Date and time components are separated by
                        a single space: 2006-08-07 12:34:56-06:00
-s, --set=STRING        set time described by STRING
-u, --utc, --universal  print or set Coordinated Universal Time
--help                 display this help and exit
--version               output version information and exit
```

Another way of getting help is by using the `--help` option to a command. Most commands allow you to pass an argument of `--help` to view basic command usage

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ ls /usr/share/doc
adduser          libdrm2          libx11-data
apt              libedit2         libxau6
ascii            libelf1          libxcb1
base-files       libffi6          libxdmcp6
base-passwd      libgcc1          libxext6
bash             libgcrypt1       libxml2
bind9            libgdbm3         libxmuu1
bind9-host       libgeoip1        locales
bind9utils       libgettextpo0    login
bsdmainutils     libglib2.0-0     logrotate
bsdutils         libgnutls26      lsb-base
busybox-initramfs libgomp1         makedev
bzip2            libgpg-error0    man-db
ca-certificates  libgpm2          mawk
coreutils        libgssapi-krb5-2 mc
cpio             libgssapi3-heimdal mc-data
cron             libhcrypto4-heimdal mime-support
curl             libheimbase1-heimdal mlocate
dash            libheimt1m0-heimdal module-init-tools

```

Some system features also have more detailed help documents located in the `/usr/share/doc` directory structure.

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ locate crontab
/etc/crontab
/usr/bin/crontab
/usr/share/bash-completion/completions/crontab
/usr/share/doc/cron/examples/crontab2english.pl
/usr/share/man/man1/crontab.1.gz
/usr/share/man/man5/crontab.5.gz
sysadmin@localhost:~$

```

An easy way to search for a file is to use the `locate` command.

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ locate -b /etc/crontab
/usr/bin/crontab
/usr/share/bash-completion/completions/crontab
sysadmin@localhost:~$

```

To find files that are just named `crontab`

```

sysadmin@localhost:~$ whereis passwd
passwd: /usr/bin/passwd /etc/passwd /usr/share/man/man1/passwd.1.gz /usr/share/man/man1/passwd.1ss1.gz /usr/share/man/man5/passwd.5.gz
sysadmin@localhost:~$

```

The `whereis` command does not search for just any file, only for commands and man pages.